

Strategic LLM applications *for institutional transformation.*

A TWO-HOUR WORKING SESSION FOR THE ACADEMIC
SENATE. YOU LEAVE WITH A METHOD, NOT A TOOL
LIST.

*Leave with something
you'll actually use
on Monday.*

THE STARTING FORMULA

*From nothing
to adequate.*

TASK + CONTEXT + OUTPUT FORMAT

→ Prompt Guide

THE STARTING FORMULA

TASK + CONTEXT + OUTPUT FORMAT

Task: What you need done. A specific verb, a specific object, a specific deliverable.

THE STARTING FORMULA

TASK + CONTEXT + OUTPUT FORMAT

Task: What you need done.

Context: The information the model needs to do it well. Your institution. Your data. Your constraints.

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THE STARTING FORMULA

TASK

+

CONTEXT

+

OUTPUT FORMAT

- Task:

What you need done.
- Context:

The information the model needs.
- Output:

How results are delivered. Table, score, memo, bullets, 300-word draft. Specify it.

From adequate
to useful.

TASK + CONTEXT + OUTPUT + CONSTRAINTS + ROLE

→ Workshop

CONSTRAINTS — WHAT IT SHOULDN'T DO

Tell it what *not* to do.

"Do not suggest strategies requiring *budget increases*."

"Focus only on programs with *enrollment below 50* students."

"*Do not hedge*. If the data says a program is failing, say so."

ROLE — WHOSE PERSPECTIVE

Break it. *Adversarial beats supportive.*

"You are a <i>skeptical accreditation reviewer</i> ."
"You are a <i>hiring manager</i> screening accounting graduates."
"You are a <i>grant reviewer</i> looking for reasons to reject this proposal."

CONTEXT IS INTELLIGENCE

Same task. *Context added.*

TASK: Analyze retention strategies for our campus.

CONTEXT: Private university in Puerto Rico. Enrollment declined 40% from 2020 to 2024. 49% of students are working adults (25-64). 70% are Pell-eligible. Top withdrawal reason is work schedule conflicts.

This is what *Monday* looks like. Next: run it live, side-by-side, in *Context in Action*.

→ PHASE 2
LIVE DEMO ↗

● THREE SIGNS OF A BAD PROMPT

If the answer is *this*, your prompt is *that*.

i. *Generic output* — you forgot context about your institution.
Fix: add who you are, what you know, what's true of your students.

ii. *Unusable output* — you forgot constraints (budget, timeline, resources).
Fix: "Implementable this year, no new budget, ≤ 90 days."

iii. *Consultant-speak* — you asked for "best practices" instead of solving a real problem.
Fix: describe a specific decision you need to make on Monday.

THE ENROLLMENT QUESTION

Nobody wants to ask it. *So we will.*

YEAR	ENROLLMENT	CHANGE
2020	6,826	—
2021	5,774	-15%
2022	5,001	-27%
2023	4,360	-36%
2024	4,101	-40%

SOURCE: IPEDS PUBLIC DATA • UNIT ID 242653

—40%

If enrollment drops another *20%*, which programs close? A committee of thirty won't answer that. *An LLM will.*

What you're *expected* to know.

FOUNDATION GPT-4o, GPT-4.5, o1, o3, o4-mini (OpenAI) · Claude Opus, Sonnet, Haiku (Anthropic) · Gemini Ultra, Pro, Flash (Google)

More. Every *month*.

FOUNDATION GPT-4o, GPT-4.5, o1, o3, o4-mini · Claude Opus, Sonnet, Haiku · Gemini Ultra, Pro, Flash · Llama 3, 4 (Meta) · Mistral Large, Codestral
· Command R+ (Cohere) · Grok (xAI) · DeepSeek V3, R1 · Qwen 2.5, QwQ (Alibaba) · Phi-4 (Microsoft)

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THE LANDSCAPE

FOUNDATION

GPT, Claude, Gemini, Llama, Mistral, Command R+, Grok, DeepSeek, Qwen, Phi

CODING

GitHub Copilot, Claude Code, Cursor, Windsurf, Aider, Amazon Q Developer, Cline, Replit Agent, Devin, v0, Bolt, Lovable

IMAGE / VIDEO / AUDIO

DALL-E 3, Midjourney v6, Stable Diffusion, Flux, Firefly · Sora, Runway Gen-3, Kling, Pika · ElevenLabs, Suno, Udio, NotebookLM

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THE LANDSCAPE

RETRIEVAL / AGENTS	RAG, LangChain, LlamaIndex, CrewAI, AutoGen, MCP, function calling, tool use, multi-agent, computer use, memory
FINE-TUNING	LoRA, QLoRA, RLHF, DPO, Constitutional AI, Custom GPTs, Claude Projects, prompt caching, 128K-1M+ context
INFRASTRUCTURE	Hugging Face, Ollama, vLLM, GGUF, AWS Bedrock, Azure OpenAI, Vertex AI, Groq, Together, Fireworks, Modal, Replicate

THE LANDSCAPE

EVALUATION / SAFETY	Red teaming, prompt injection, jailbreaking, hallucination detection, MMLU · HumanEval · GPQA · ARC-AGI, alignment, interpretability, watermarking
EMERGING (2025-26)	Reasoning models (chain-of-thought, extended thinking) · computer-use agents · deep research agents · real-time voice · multimodal (text+image+audio+video) · code execution · structured outputs · citations

This list is already outdated.
No one person can learn all of this. No one should try.

● AI BURNOUT · TYPE 1 – THE CATCHING-UP TRAP

The stages of *falling behind*.

01	<i>Awareness</i>	that something important is changing.
02	<i>Effort</i>	to keep up – reading, experimenting, attending workshops.
03	<i>Recognition</i>	that the gap between what you know and what exists is widening despite the effort.
04	<i>Dread</i>	that falling behind carries professional consequences.
05	<i>Exhaustion</i>	from the effort coupled with the sense of futility. <i>Acceptance is the way out.</i>

● AI BURNOUT · TYPE 2 – THE STRATEGIC-THINKING TRAP

The feedback loop that *eats your day*.

01	<i>Leverage</i>	better thinking produces better AI output.
02	<i>Reinforcement</i>	better output confirms the value of investing more thought.
03	<i>Compulsion</i>	the high return on thinking makes it addictive.
04	<i>Disappearance</i>	30 minutes becomes 4 hours. A workday in continuous strategic thinking is more cognitively demanding than most people expect.
05	<i>Silence</i>	the exhaustion is real but difficult to name.

DISCUSSION · FOLLOW-UP

Questions?

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→ Repository